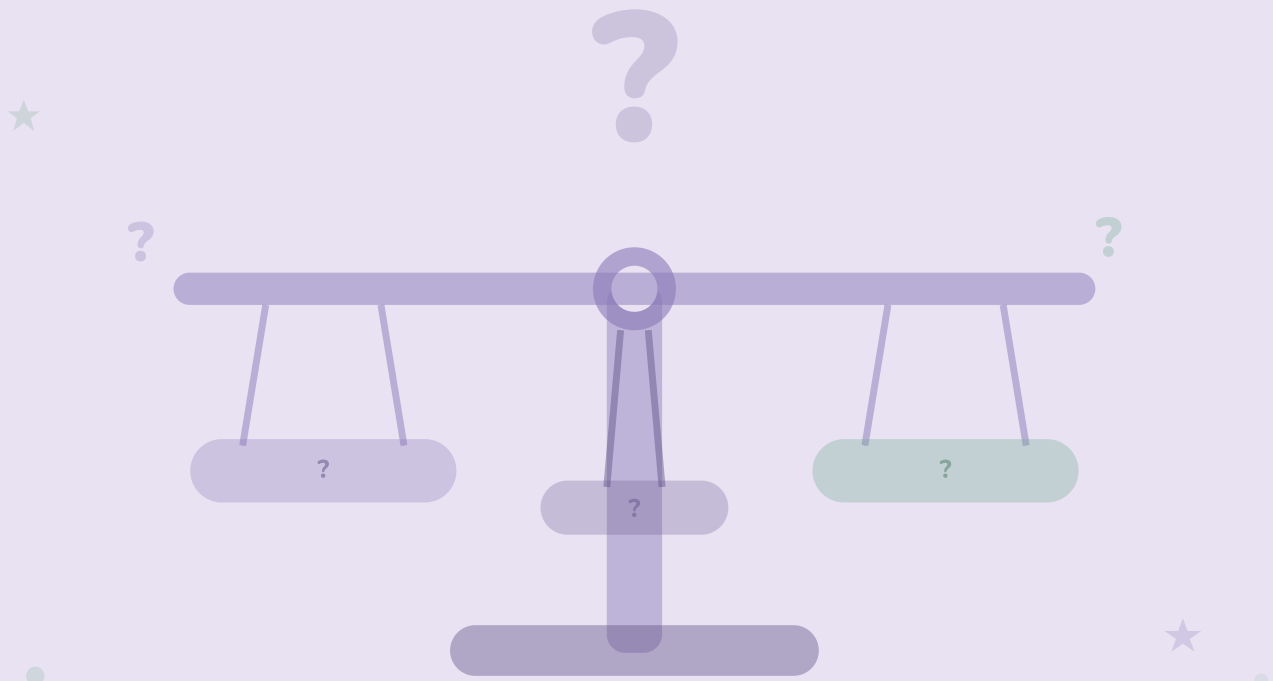
CAN AI KNOW WHAT IS FAIR?

Can AI decide what is fair?



DIVIDE

DEBATE

CHOOSE

CAN AI KNOW WHAT IS FAIR?

Children often assume a machine is fair because it follows rules. This card shows that fair is not always the same as equal, and that people — not algorithms — decide which rule fits a situation.

MAIN ACTIVITY

1. Place three characters on the board. Give the class 12 stickers. Ask: "How should we share them?"
2. Add new info (one child did extra work, one was sick, one needs more support). Ask: "Should the stickers still be shared equally?"
3. Introduce an AI rule. Try *same for everyone*, then *more for need* or *more for effort*. Ask which rule feels fair, and who chose it.
4. Read quick fairness scenarios. Students move to *Fair*, *Not Fair*, or *Not Sure* and explain their reasoning.

MATERIALS

- 12 counters or stickers
- 3 character cards
- 4–6 short fairness scenarios
- Room signs: *Fair*, *Not Fair*, *Not Sure*

REFLECTION

- Is *equal* always *fair*?
- Can one rule be fair in every situation?
- Who should decide what fairness means?

REALITY CHECK

AI can apply a rule perfectly — but people decide which rule is fair.

Context changes everything. A rule that works in class may be unfair in a hospital, and a rule that works now may not work next year.

DIGITAL GAME

Fairness Lab — Try different rules

Scan to play →